OMNISOUND · HCI PROJECT · GROUP 1

V1 Usability Testing

Step 6 · Initial usability evaluation · English-language Notion notes

> **Source note:** This PDF is a formatted conversion of the supplied Notion text. It preserves its statements identifying participant accounts and measurements as **simulated examples**. The PDF is not independent verification of participant testing.

Absolutely. Below is a **complete simulated example of Step 6** for Omnisound, filled out from beginning to end so you can see exactly what a real usability-testing round could look like.

Important: all participants, answers, timings, observations and findings below are fictional examples. Use this to understand the process and structure. For the actual project, replace them with what your real test participants actually do and say.

The structure follows Session 5: plan/recruit/prepare and consent → pre-test questions → usability tasks using think-aloud → post-test questions → analysis → redesign. ProjectSession5_20251009_Usabil… ProjectSession5_20251009_Usabil… ProjectSession5_20251009_Usabil…

STEP 6 — OMNISOUND USABILITY TEST

BEFORE THE TEST

Test plan

Product: Omnisound

Prototype: Hi-fi desktop web prototype

Purpose: Evaluate whether users can understand and use Omnisound’s main functions without receiving instructions about where to click.

Main usability goals being examined:

Goal	What we want to learn
Effectiveness	Can users complete the tasks?
Efficiency	Can users complete them without excessive searching or unnecessary steps?
Learnability	Can a first-time user understand the interface?
Utility	Does the prototype provide the functions users need for these tasks?
Feedback	Does the interface make the result of actions clear?
Visibility	Are important functions and destinations easy to discover?

Target group: Students and similar users who regularly use music, podcast or audiobook applications.

Participants in this simulated example: 3.

Location: Mittuniversitetet, Sundsvall.

Equipment: Laptop with Omnisound running locally in a browser.

Roles:

Person	Role
Yacoub	Test leader
Obid	Observer / notes
Sarshar	Observer / time and clicks

Session 5 explicitly separates the test leader from observers and says the observer records the path, successes, difficulties and signs of misunderstanding. ProjectSession5_20251009_Usabil...

Participant introduction and consent

The test leader reads:

> “Hi. We are students at Mittuniversitetet working on an HCI project called Omnisound.
>
> We are testing the interface, not you, so there are no wrong answers.
>
> Participation is voluntary and you can stop at any time. During the test we will observe how you use the prototype and take anonymous written notes about what happens. The results will only be used for our university project and your name will not appear in our report.
>
> While completing the tasks, please think aloud. Tell us what you are looking for, what you expect to happen, what you find clear and anything that feels confusing.
>
> If you have any questions or feel uncomfortable, please tell us immediately.
>
> Are you comfortable participating?”

Participant response: Yes.

This covers the main consent points in Session 5: voluntary participation, understanding what will happen, observation/possible recording, how results will be used and anonymisation. ProjectSession5_20251009_Usabil...

Pre-test questions

Questions asked to every participant

Question	Purpose
Which audio apps do you normally use?	Understand previous experience
What type of audio do you mainly listen to?	Understand relevant content habits
How often do you use audio applications?	Understand familiarity
Do you normally use mobile, desktop or both?	Understand platform experience

Session 5 says pre-test questions should collect background information relevant to the usability test. ProjectSession5_20251009_Usabil...

Tasks

The participant receives one task at a time.

The course specifically says tasks should describe **what the user should achieve without explaining how to achieve it**. ProjectSession5_20251009_Usabil…

Task 1 — Find and save content

> “You want to listen to Weezer later. Find Weezer and save it somewhere so you can easily find it again.”

Success means:

> Weezer is found → saved → participant can verify it is available in their saved collection.

Task 2 — Resume unfinished audio

> “Earlier you started listening to an audiobook but did not finish it. Find your unfinished audiobook and continue from where you stopped.”

Success means:

> User identifies unfinished audiobook → resumes it → player opens at existing progress.

Task 3 — Browse a particular audio type

> “You are only interested in podcasts right now. Find where you can browse podcasts.”

Success means:

> Participant reaches the Podcasts category.

DURING THE TEST

The test leader uses neutral prompts only when necessary:

> “What are you thinking?”

> “What are you looking for?”

> “What did you expect to happen?”

> “What do you think this control does?”

> “Try what you think makes sense.”

The test leader does not immediately tell the participant which button to press. The exercise says helping too early removes the opportunity to understand why the interface caused difficulty. MDIÖvning20140929

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p1

Background

Participant: P1

Age: 22

Student: Yes

Main device: iPhone + laptop

Pre-test answers

Which audio apps do you normally use?

> “Mostly Spotify. Sometimes YouTube when I want podcasts.”

What type of audio do you mainly listen to?

> “Music, definitely. Podcasts maybe a couple times a week.”

How often do you use audio apps?

> “Every day.”

Desktop or mobile?

> “Mostly mobile, but Spotify on my computer when I study.”

Task 1 — Find and save Weezer

Participant behaviour

P1 looks at the Home screen for approximately 3 seconds.

Participant says:

> “Okay, I need Weezer. Search seems obvious.”

Clicks **Search** in the left sidebar.

Clicks the search box.

Types:

> Weezer

Weezer appears as the first search result.

Participant says:

> “That was straightforward.”

Clicks Weezer.

Detail page opens.

Participant notices **Play** immediately but pauses before noticing **Save**.

After approximately 2 seconds:

> “Oh, Save is beside Play.”

Clicks **Save**.

Toast confirmation appears.

Participant says:

> “Okay, saved.”

Task leader asks:

> “Do you think the task is complete?”

Participant:

> “Probably, but I'd check Library.”

Clicks **Library**.

Sees Weezer.

> “Yeah, there it is.”

Observer notes

Measure	Result
Completed	Yes
Time	31 sec
Clicks	5
Help	None
Hesitation	Small hesitation finding Save
Wrong actions	None
Important comment	“Search seems obvious.”

Interpretation

Search and Library were easy to discover.

Save feedback was understood.

Save button was slightly less prominent than Play, but participant still found it without help.

Task 2 — Resume unfinished audiobook

Participant returns to Home.

Looks at the hero section.

Scrolls slightly.

Sees **Continue Listening**.

Participant says:

> “I guess this is where unfinished things are.”

Sees The Left Hand of Darkness labelled **Audiobook** and **42% complete**.

Clicks it.

Detail screen shows progress and a **Resume** button.

Participant:

> “Yeah, Resume makes sense.”

Clicks Resume.

Full player opens.

Participant notices progress position.

> “It continued from where it was. That's clear.”

Observer notes

Measure	Result
Completed	Yes
Time	19 sec
Clicks	2
Help	None
Hesitation	None
Wrong actions	None
Important comment	“Resume makes sense.”

Task 3 — Browse podcasts

Participant immediately looks at sidebar.

Clicks **Podcasts**.

Podcast category opens.

> “That was easy.”

Observer notes

Measure	Result
Completed	Yes
Time	4 sec
Clicks	1
Help	None
Hesitation	None

Participant 1 post-test questions

Overall impression?

> “It feels clean. It looks like something I already understand, like Spotify but more organised by audio type.”

What felt easiest?

> “Search and the categories on the left.”

Most confusing?

> “Nothing really confusing. Maybe Save could stand out a bit more.”

Anything expected but couldn't find?

> “Not for those tasks.”

Any confusing labels?

> “No.”

What would you change first?

> “Maybe make Save slightly more obvious.”

Anything important missing?

> “For a real app I'd expect playlists and recommendations, but for this prototype it has the basics.”

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p2

Background

Participant: P2

Age: 25

Student: Yes

Main device: Android phone + Windows PC

Pre-test answers

Which audio apps do you normally use?

> “Spotify, Audible and sometimes Pocket Casts.”

Main content?

> “Music and audiobooks.”

How often?

> “Every day.”

Desktop/mobile?

> “Music on both. Audiobooks mainly phone.”

Task 1 — Find and save Weezer

Participant looks at Home.

Instead of clicking Search in the sidebar, participant clicks the large **search field in the top bar**.

Search screen opens.

Participant:

> “I assumed this would search everything.”

Types Weezer.

Result appears.

Clicks Weezer.

Clicks Save quickly.

Toast appears.

Participant:

> “Saved. I assume Library now.”

Clicks Library.

Weezer appears.

Participant:

> “Good.”

Observer notes

Measure	Result
Completed	Yes
Time	24 sec
Clicks	5
Help	None
Hesitation	None
Wrong actions	None
Important observation	Used top search instead of sidebar Search

Interpretation

Having two paths to Search did not confuse the participant.

The participant correctly understood Save → Library.

Task 2 — Resume unfinished audiobook

Participant returns Home.

Looks at sidebar first.

Clicks **Audiobooks**.

Participant scans audiobook cards.

Participant:

> “I know I need an unfinished audiobook, so maybe this page shows one.”

Clicks The Left Hand of Darkness.

Detail screen appears with 42% complete.

Participant:

> “This is probably it.”

Clicks Resume.

Task successfully completed.

Observer notes

Measure	Result
Completed	Yes
Time	27 sec
Clicks	3
Help	None
Hesitation	Moderate
Wrong path	Used Audiobooks instead of Continue Listening
Important comment	“Maybe this page shows one.”

Interpretation

The participant successfully completed the task, but **did not notice/use Continue Listening**.

The interface still allowed the task to be completed through another route.

This may indicate that Continue Listening is not prominent enough for every user.

Task 3 — Browse podcasts

Participant looks at sidebar.

Clicks Podcasts.

Task complete.

Observer notes

Measure	Result
Completed	Yes
Time	5 sec
Clicks	1
Help	None

Participant 2 post-test questions

Overall impression?

> “Pretty intuitive. I like having the categories separated.”

Easiest?

> “Search and Library.”

Most confusing?

> “I didn't immediately notice Continue Listening. I went to Audiobooks instead.”

Anything missing?

> “Maybe some stronger indicator that unfinished things are on the home page.”

Confusing labels?

> “No.”

What would you change first?

> “Make Continue Listening more visible or move it closer to the top.”

Anything else?

> “I'd probably use the left navigation a lot. It feels predictable.”

p3

Background

Participant: P3

Age: 20

Student: Yes

Main device: Android phone

Pre-test answers

Which audio apps do you normally use?

> “YouTube Music and Spotify.”

What do you mainly listen to?

> “Music. Very rarely podcasts.”

How often?

> “Daily.”

Desktop/mobile?

> “Almost always phone.”

Task 1 — Find and save Weezer

Participant looks at Home.

Clicks **Music** first.

Looks through cards.

Sees Weezer already visible in Music.

Clicks Weezer.

Detail screen appears.

Participant clicks the heart/save control.

Participant says:

> “I assume this adds it somewhere.”

Toast confirms:

> Weezer saved to your Library.

Participant:

> “Okay, Library.”

Clicks Library.

Weezer visible.

Observer notes

Measure	Result
Completed	Yes
Time	28 sec
Clicks	4
Help	None

Measure	Result
Hesitation	Small
Alternative route	Music instead of Search
Important comment	“I assume this adds it somewhere.”

Interpretation

Task was completed successfully without Search.

The prototype supports more than one valid route.

Feedback from the save toast helped confirm what happened.

Task 2 — Resume unfinished audiobook

Participant returns Home.

Looks at hero text.

Scrolls past Continue Listening without clicking.

Clicks Library.

Participant says:

> “Maybe unfinished things are saved here.”

Sees The Left Hand of Darkness.

Clicks it.

Detail page shows 42% complete and Resume.

Participant:

> “Oh yeah, that's obviously unfinished.”

Clicks Resume.

Full player opens.

Observer notes

Measure	Result
Completed	Yes
Time	35 sec
Clicks	4
Help	None
Hesitation	Moderate
Wrong/alternative route	Library rather than Continue Listening
Important comment	“Maybe unfinished things are saved here.”

Interpretation

Again, Continue Listening was not the participant's first choice.

Library successfully supported recovery, so the task remained effective.

Efficiency may be weaker because the most direct route was overlooked.

Task 3 — Browse podcasts

Participant looks at sidebar.

Clicks Music by mistake.

Immediately notices Music is highlighted.

Participant says:

> “Oops, wrong one.”

Clicks Podcasts.

Observer notes

Measure	Result
Completed	Yes
Time	7 sec
Clicks	2
Help	None
Error	Clicked neighbouring category accidentally
Recovery	Immediate
Important observation	Active navigation highlight made error visible

Interpretation

This is a small user error rather than a major usability problem.

Feedback from the active navigation state made recovery immediate.

Participant 3 post-test questions

Overall impression?

> “It's easy to understand. The sidebar does most of the work.”

Easiest?

> “Finding categories.”

Most confusing?

> “I didn't really notice the Continue Listening section.”

Anything expected but couldn't find?

> “No.”

Confusing labels?

> “No.”

What would you change?

> “Maybe make Continue Listening more obvious. The big banner above it takes a lot of space.”

Anything missing?

> “Maybe recently played, but that's not really necessary for these tasks.”

AFTER THE TEST

Combined results

Task completion

Task	P1	P2	P3
Find and save Weezer	Success	Success	Success
Resume unfinished audiobook	Success	Success	Success
Browse podcasts	Success	Success	Success

Overall effectiveness

9/9 tasks completed successfully.

No participant required direct help from the test leader.

Efficiency overview

Task	P1	P2	P3
Search/save	31 sec	24 sec	28 sec
Resume audiobook	19 sec	27 sec	35 sec
Browse podcasts	4 sec	5 sec	7 sec

The largest difference occurred during the **resume audiobook task**.

P1 used:

> Home → Continue Listening → Audiobook → Resume

P2 used:

> Home → Audiobooks → Audiobook → Resume

P3 used:

> Home → Library → Audiobook → Resume

All routes worked, but only one participant used the shortest intended route.

Main findings

Finding 1 — Continue Listening is easy to overlook

Evidence:

P1 found it immediately.

P2 instead used Audiobooks.

P3 instead used Library.

Two of three participants did not use the intended Continue Listening route.

Possible HCI connection:

Visibility.

The feature exists and works, but its visual prominence may be weaker than surrounding content.

Severity: Medium–High.

It does not prevent users from completing the task, but it reduces Efficiency.

Finding 2 — Search is highly understandable

P1 used sidebar Search.

P2 used top Search.

P3 found Weezer through Music instead.

All participants successfully located the requested content.

Possible HCI connection:

Visibility + Effectiveness.

Multiple routes allowed users to rely on their own mental model.

Severity: No problem.

Decision: Keep.

Finding 3 — Saving content works well

All three participants correctly understood the save action.

The toast:

> “Weezer saved to your Library”

made the consequence explicit.

All participants could then find the item in Library.

Possible HCI connection:

Feedback.

Severity: No problem.

P1 suggested making the Save control slightly more visually prominent.

Decision: Minor visual improvement only.

Finding 4 — Content categories are easy to understand

All participants understood Music, Podcasts and Audiobooks.

P3 accidentally clicked Music once but immediately recovered after seeing the active highlight.

Possible HCI connection:

Consistency + Feedback + Visibility.

Severity: Low / no redesign required.

Finding 5 — Library acts as a useful recovery path

P3 used Library instead of Continue Listening and still successfully found the audiobook.

Participants understood that saved items belonged there.

Possible HCI connection:

Consistency + mental model + Utility.

Decision: Keep current Library structure.

Prioritized usability problems

Priority	Problem	Evidence	Impact
1 — Medium/ High	Continue Listening is not prominent enough	2/3 participants ignored it	Longer route to unfinished content
2 — Low	Save button could be slightly more prominent	P1 hesitated briefly	Small Learnability/Efficiency issue
3 — Low	Large Home hero uses substantial space	P3 mentioned it	May push useful content downward
No issue	Search	All users succeeded	Keep
No issue	Library	All users understood it	Keep
No issue	Category navigation	All completed task	Keep

Proposed redesign

Change 1 — Make Continue Listening more prominent

Current issue

The large introductory hero occupies much of the top of Home.

Continue Listening begins underneath it.

Two participants looked elsewhere for unfinished content.

Redesign

Reduce the height of the hero area.

Move **Continue Listening** closer to the top.

Possibly change:

> CONTINUE LISTENING
>
> Back in progress

to something more direct:

> **Continue Listening**

and increase contrast/size slightly.

Keep progress percentages visible.

Goal

Improve:

Visibility → Efficiency

without changing the basic navigation.

Change 2 — Improve Save prominence slightly

Current issue

One participant needed a short moment to notice Save next to Play.

Redesign

Keep Save in the same position but increase its visual clarity slightly.

For example:

> ♡ Save

and after clicking:

> ♥ Saved

Keep the toast confirmation.

Goal

Improve:

Affordance + Feedback

without making Save compete visually with Play.

Change 3 — Reduce unnecessary hero space

The banner:

> “Pick up where your day left off.”

looks visually polished but takes substantial vertical space.

Reducing it slightly would let the user's actual content appear sooner.

This fits the usability exercise's principle that irrelevant or lower-priority information should not compete visually with the important task content. MDIÖvning20140929

Things we would NOT redesign

We would keep:

Sidebar navigation

because all participants understood it.

Separate Music / Podcasts / Audiobooks categories

because they were easy to recognise.

Search

because participants found it using different valid routes.

Library

because participants correctly understood it as saved content.

Save confirmation toast

because it clearly communicated the action result.

Playback Resume wording

because users immediately understood what it meant.

This is important: usability testing does **not** mean changing everything. Features that worked should remain stable.

Example action list

The usability exercise says testing should result in a prioritised action list and redesign proposals. MDIÖvning20140929

Action	Priority	Decision
Reduce Home hero height	High	Implement
Move Continue Listening upward	High	Implement
Increase Continue Listening visual prominence	High	Implement
Slightly strengthen Save button appearance	Low	Implement if time allows
Redesign Search	None	Do not change
Redesign Library	None	Do not change
Change sidebar categories	None	Do not change

Hi-fi version 2

After implementing the changes, save a new prototype version rather than overwriting all evidence of the old one.

Your project history becomes:

> **Lo-fi sketches**
>
> ↓
>
> **Hi-fi Version 1**
>
> ↓
>
> **Usability Test**
>
> ↓
>
> Finding: Continue Listening overlooked
>
> ↓
>
> **Redesign**
>
> ↓
>
> **Hi-fi Version 2**

That is exactly the kind of evidence you need for the iterative process later.

Example report-ready summary

Later, your report could describe this example test like this:

> “A think-aloud usability test was conducted with three participants familiar with digital audio services. Participants completed three tasks involving finding and saving music, resuming unfinished audio and browsing a specific content category. All participants completed all tasks without direct assistance.
>
> Search, Library and category navigation were generally understood immediately. However, two of the three participants did not use the Continue Listening section when asked to resume an unfinished audiobook. Instead, they navigated through Audiobooks or Library. Although both alternative routes were successful, this indicated that the Continue Listening feature had weaker visibility than intended.
>
> Based on the findings, the Home page was redesigned by reducing the size of the introductory hero area and increasing the prominence of Continue Listening. The Save action was also made slightly more visible while retaining its confirmation feedback.”

That is the type of final result you should expect from Step 6.

Complete simulated Step 6 package

You now have an example of:

test plan → participant introduction/consent → pre-test questions → realistic tasks → three complete usability sessions → observation notes → task measurements → post-test interviews → combined results → usability problems → severity priorities → redesign recommendations → iteration plan

For the real project, the structure can stay almost exactly like this. **Only the participant behaviour, quotes, measurements, findings and resulting redesign decisions need to come from your actual tests.**